

To see why the Law of the Excluded Middle (LEM) leads to fate, consider a proposition about a possible future free action of yours.

The law of the excluded middle

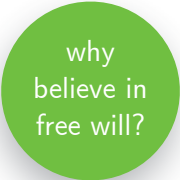
For any proposition P , either P is true or $\text{Not-}P$ is true.



two
arguments
against free
will



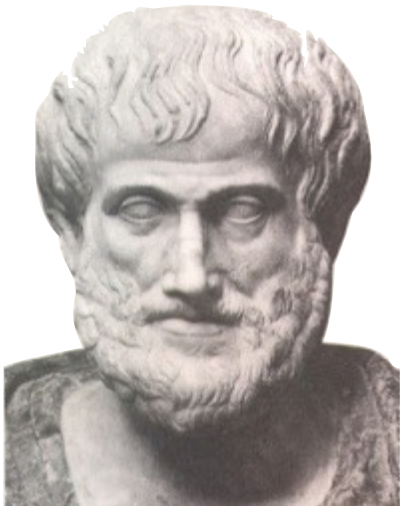
is fate
real?



why
believe in
free will?



three
ways out



You will get married
on July 1, 2030.

You will not get married
on July 1, 2030.

But notice that, whichever of these is true, there is now a truth about whether you will get married on that day. So fate is real.

And nothing depended on this particular choice of an example. So,
for any possible future action of yours, there is now a truth about
whether and when you will perform it.

fate, consider a proposition about a possible future free

action of yours.

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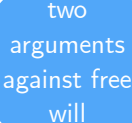
The Law of the excluded middle

For any proposition P , either P is

Not-IP is true.

Our first topic today is the oldest challenge to the existence of free will: the challenge to

freedom that comes from fate.



two
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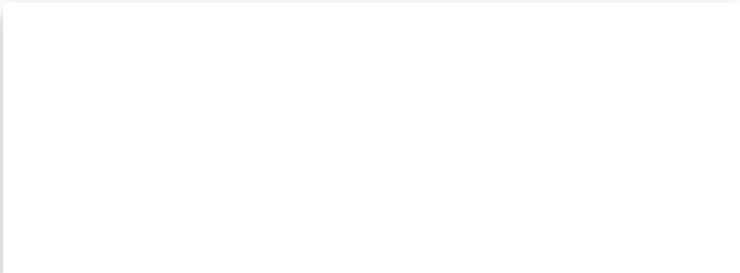
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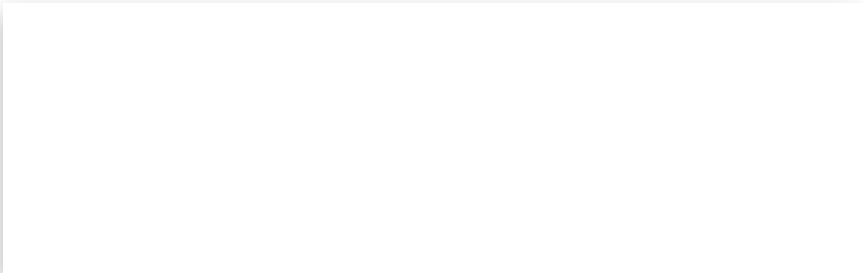


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first let's think about how Edwards'

We'll shortly consider some ways of

responding to Edwards' argument. But

for fatalsn.

argument might be related to an argument

Suppose that someone did not believe in

there were truths about all our future

God— and hence rejected premise (2) of

Edwards' argument — but did believe that

similar to Edwards' argument?

actions. Could they give an argument

replace reference to God's foreknowledge

with reference to the being of truth about

(5) Let's look at what happens if we

God only shows up in premises (2) and

our future actions.



1. We have no direct facts.

all of our activities.

choice about the fact that if p , then q ,

some action, then I will prefer that

2* In the past, there were truths about

4. If we have no choice about p , and no

3 We have not at the fact that

God knows that in the future I will

that if it is true that I will perform

perform a certain action (1,2)

then we have the choice about q.

acaioid.

5* We have noticed that the fact

0 We have achieved what we



(3, 4, 5)

will perform various actions.

The fatalist argument

So now consider a possible scenario in which someone exactly like you would get

never had any. So they lacked free will before getting a Predicto.

a Predictor. By the above line of thought, this person would lack free will. But

that Predict did not **take away** their free will; it just shows them that they

But this person was stipulated to be exactly like you. So you don't have free will,

either.

and the example of the Predictor — which seem to show that if there is such a

things as fate, then there is no free will.

So far we've looked at two imaginary thought experiments—the story of Osmo,

serious challenge to the reality of free will?

Our question is: do either fatigue or foreknowledge pose a

To see what Aristotle is thinking, let's look at two

propositions about possible future free action of yours.



The Law of the Land

For any proposition P , either P is true or Not- P

indivisible.

of these claims is true, and one of them is false.

So it must be that, if the law of the excluded middle is true, then

But to endorse this is just to believe in fate, since it is to say that

day.

there is no truth about whether you will get married or that

You will not get married
on June 1, 2027.

You will get married on
June 1, 2027.

We might call this the logical argument for fate:

whether and when you will perform it.

And nothing depends on this particular choice of an example. So,

for any possible future action of yours, there is now a truth about